FUNCTIONS OF DIPLOMACY

Morgenthau[15] provides four functions of diplomacy. These functions imply that one must:

1. determine the objectives of diplomacy in light of power actually and potentially available for the pursuit of these objectives;
2. assess the objectives of other nations and the power actually and potentially available for the pursuit of those objectives;
3. determine to what extent these different objectives are compatible with each other; and
4. employ the means suited to the pursuit of its objectives.

To him a diplomat fulfills three basic functions for his government: symbolic, legal and political.

Palmer and Perkins classify the functions of diplomats as:

1. Representation
2. Negotiation
3. Reporting
4. Protection of national interests and nationals abroad.

To this category another one, can be added, that is, the maintenance of international peace and promotion of international cooperation.

Poullada[16] points out that diplomacy performs five substantive functions:

1. Conflict management
2. Problem solving
3. Cross-cultural interaction on a wide range of issues
4. Negotiation and bargaining
5. Programme management of the foreign policy decisions of one country to another.

For the performance of these substantive functions, procedurally communicating the views of one's government and exchanging information, is involved. This is best done by the diplomats using certain procedural arts and crafts such as the refinements of protocol, diplomatic drafting, press relations and even gastronomy.